TRANSPARENCY, RTI AND INFORMATION SHARING

INFORMATION-GOVERNANCE DISTINCTION MAP → RTI SCOPE AND RIGHTS-HOLDER → SECTION 4 PROACTIVE-DISCLOSURE ENGINE → SECTIONS 6 AND 7 → SECTION 8 EXEMPTION AND → SEVERABILITY AND THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW · SUBORDINATE EXTRA · APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g1 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 INFORMATION-GOVERNANCE DISTINCTION MAP

INFORMATION-GOVERNANCE DISTINCTION MAP · CENTRAL FOCUS · 1. INFORMATION-GOVERNANCE DISTINCTION MAP · (1) TRANSPARENCY · SYSTEMIC VISIBILITY · (2) DISCLOSURE · PARTICULAR RELEASE · (3) SHARING

CENTRAL FOCUS

1. Information-governance distinction map → (1) Transparency: systemic visibility → (2) Disclosure: particular release

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 1. Information-governance distinction map
- [1] Transparency: systemic visibility
- [2] Disclosure: particular release

MECHANISM
- [3] Sharing: purpose-bound exchange
- [4] Open data: reusable datasets
- [5] Privacy: dignity and control
- [6] Accountability: answerability

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Forum supplies correction
- [8] Law sets legitimate limits
- VERDICT → Moving information is not identical to making power accountable.
- ANSWER USE → Use to define the topic and prevent synonym traps.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Moving information is not identical to making power accountable.

01 RTI SCOPE AND RIGHTS-HOLDER ROUTE

RTI SCOPE AND RIGHTS-HOLDER ROUTE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 2. RTI SCOPE AND RIGHTS-HOLDER ROUTE · (1) SECTION 3 · CITIZEN'S RIGHT · (2) IDENTIFY PUBLIC AUTHORITY · (3) LOCATE HELD OR CONTROLLED RECORD · (4) INCLUDE LAW-ACCESSIBLE PRIVATE DATA

CENTRAL FOCUS → 2: RTI scope and rights-holder route → (1) Section 3: citizen's right → (2) Identify public authority → (3) Locate held or controlled record

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 2. RTI scope and rights-holder route
- [1] Section 3: citizen's right
- [2] Identify public authority

MECHANISM
- [3] Locate held or controlled record
- [4] Include law-accessible private data
- [5] Do not demand new opinion
- [6] Applicant need not give reasons

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Assist persons needing help
- [8] Apply exemptions only afterward
- VERDICT → RTI opens existing recorded information; it does not compel fresh intellectual creation.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Sections 2, 3 and 6 answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — RTI opens existing recorded information; it does not compel fresh intellectual creation.

02 SECTION 4 PROACTIVE-DISCLOSURE ENGINE

SECTION 4 PROACTIVE-DISCLOSURE ENGINE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 3. SECTION 4 PROACTIVE-DISCLOSURE ENGINE · (1) CATALOGUE AND INDEX RECORDS · (2) COMPUTERISE APPROPRIATE RECORDS · (3) PUBLISH ORGANISATION AND DUTIES · (4) PUBLISH NORMS AND DECISION PROCESS · (5) PUBLISH BUDGET AND PROGRAMMES

CENTRAL FOCUS → 3: Section 4 proactive-disclosure engine → (1) Catalogue and index records → (2) Computerise appropriate records → (3) Publish organisation and duties

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 3. Section 4 proactive-disclosure engine
- [1] Catalogue and index records
- [2] Computerise appropriate records

MECHANISM
- [3] Publish organisation and duties
- [4] Publish norms and decision process
- [5] Publish budget and programmes
- [6] Publish subsidies and concessions

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Update, search and make accessible
- [8] Minimise need for applications
- VERDICT → The strongest RTI system answers routine questions before they become disputes.
- ANSWER USE → Use for reform, capacity and anti-corruption answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — The strongest RTI system answers routine questions before they become disputes.

03 SECTIONS 6 AND 7 REQUEST CLOCK

SECTIONS 6 AND 7 REQUEST CLOCK · CENTRAL FOCUS · 4. SECTIONS 6 AND 7 REQUEST CLOCK · (1) FILE WRITTEN OR ELECTRONIC REQUEST · (2) USE ENGLISH, HINDI OR LOCAL OFFICIAL LANGUAGE · (3) GIVE CONTACT DETAIL, NOT REASONS · (4) TRANSFER UNDER SECTION 6(3) · (5) ORDINARY DECISION

CENTRAL FOCUS → 4: Sections 6 and 7 request clock → (1) File written or electronic request → (2) Use English, Hindi or local official language → (3) Give contact detail, not reasons

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 4. Sections 6 and 7 request clock
- [1] File written or electronic request
- [2] Use English, Hindi or local official language

MECHANISM
- [3] Give contact detail, not reasons
- [4] Transfer under Section 6(3)
- [5] Ordinary decision: thirty days
- [6] Life or liberty: forty-eight hours

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Silence becomes deemed refusal
- [8] Delay makes information free
- VERDICT → Access is meaningful only when procedure is simple, assisted and time-bound.
- ANSWER USE → Use for application and timeline close-option questions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Access is meaningful only when procedure is simple, assisted and time-bound.

04 SECTION 8 EXEMPTION AND BALANCE

SECTION 8 EXEMPTION AND BALANCE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 5. SECTION 8 EXEMPTION AND BALANCE · (1) NAME EXACT EXEMPTION CLAUSE · (2) IDENTIFY PROTECTED INTEREST · (3) SPECIFY LIKELY DISCLOSURE HARM · (4) REJECT GENERIC CONFIDENTIALITY · (5) TEST SECTION 8(2) PUBLIC INTEREST

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 5. Section 8 exemption and balance
- [1] Name exact exemption clause
- [2] Identify protected interest

MECHANISM
- [3] Specify likely disclosure harm
- [4] Reject generic confidentiality
- [5] Test Section 8(2) public interest
- [6] Consider twenty-year rule

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Record clause-linked reasons
- [8] Preserve appeal and review
- VERDICT → A protected interest requires a reasoned harm analysis, not a secrecy label.
- ANSWER USE → Use for exemptions, OSA and public-interest questions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — A protected interest requires a reasoned harm analysis, not a secrecy label.

05 SEVERABILITY AND THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE

SEVERABILITY AND THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 6. SEVERABILITY AND THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE · (1) IDENTIFY PROTECTED SEGMENT · (2) TEST REASONABLE SEPARATION · (3) RELEASE NON-EXEMPT REMAINDER · (4) NOTIFY REASONS AND REVIEW RIGHTS · (5) NOTIFY AFFECTED THIRD PARTY

CENTRAL FOCUS → 6: Severability and third-party procedure → (1) Identify protected segment → (2) Test reasonable separation → (3) Release non-exempt remainder

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 6. Severability and third-party procedure
- [1] Identify protected segment
- [2] Test reasonable separation

MECHANISM
- [3] Release non-exempt remainder
- [4] Notify reasons and review rights
- [5] Notify affected third party
- [6] Receive timely representation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] PIO decides independently
- [8] Notify both sides of appeal
- VERDICT → Redaction narrows secrecy; consultation improves fairness without creating a veto.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Sections 10 and 11.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Redaction narrows secrecy; consultation improves fairness without creating a veto.

06 APPEAL, BURDEN, REMEDY AND PENALTY

APPEAL, BURDEN, REMEDY AND PENALTY · CENTRAL FOCUS · 7. APPEAL, BURDEN, REMEDY AND PENALTY · (1) PIO GIVES DECISION OR DEFAULTS · (2) FIRST APPEAL WITHIN AUTHORITY · (3) SECOND APPEAL TO COMMISSION · (4) PIO BEARS DENIAL BURDEN · (5) COMMISSION MAY ORDER ACCESS

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Appeal, burden, remedy and penalty → (1) PIO gives decision or defaults → (2) First appeal within authority

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Appeal, burden, remedy and penalty
- [1] PIO gives decision or defaults
- [2] First appeal within authority

MECHANISM
- [3] Second appeal to Commission
- [4] PIO bears denial burden
- [5] Commission may order access
- [6] Commission may require system reform

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Section 20 penalty is conditional
- [8] Persistent default may trigger discipline
- VERDICT → RTI accountability joins access, justification, correction and personal consequence.
- ANSWER USE → Use for 2018 Q2(b) and enforcement reform.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — RTI accountability joins access, justification, correction and personal consequence.

07 SECTION 24 SPECIAL BOUNDARY

SECTION 24 SPECIAL BOUNDARY · CENTRAL FOCUS · 8. SECTION 24 SPECIAL BOUNDARY · (1) CHECK NOTIFIED SECURITY ORGANISATION · (2) GENERAL EXCLUSION APPLIES · (3) TEST CORRUPTION ALLEGATION · (4) TEST HUMAN-RIGHTS ALLEGATION · (5) CORRUPTION ROUTE REMAINS OPEN

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. Section 24 special boundary → (1) Check notified security organisation → (2) General exclusion applies

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Section 24 special boundary
- [1] Check notified security organisation
- [2] General exclusion applies

MECHANISM
- [3] Test corruption allegation
- [4] Test human-rights allegation
- [5] Corruption route remains open
- [6] Human-rights route needs approval

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Apply special forty-five-day period
- [8] Protect genuine operational harm
- VERDICT → Security-organisation exclusion is broad but not absolute.
- ANSWER USE → Use for statutory traps and balanced national-security answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Security-organisation exclusion is broad but not absolute.

08 RTI AMENDMENT 2019 INSTITUTIONAL MAP

RTI AMENDMENT 2019 INSTITUTIONAL MAP · CENTRAL FOCUS · 9. RTI AMENDMENT 2019 INSTITUTIONAL MAP · (1) PRE-2019 TENURE FIXED IN ACT · (2) PRE-2019 SALARY LINKS FIXED IN ACT · (3) 2019 SHIFTS DETAIL TO CENTRAL RULES · (4) CHANGE COVERS CENTRAL COMMISSIONS · (5) CHANGE ALSO COVERS STATE COMMISSIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[3] 2019 shifts detail to Central rules	[7] Independence concern is structural
9. RTI Amendment 2019 institutional map	[4] Change covers Central Commissions	[8] Actual interference is not proved
[1] Pre-2019 tenure fixed in Act	[5] Change also covers State Commissions	VERDICT → State the design risk precisely without claiming that RTI rights were abolished.
[2] Pre-2019 salary links fixed in Act	[6] Rules prescribe three-year term	ANSWER USE → Use for institutional-independence evaluation.

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 9. RTI Amendment 2019 institutional map
- [1] Pre-2019 tenure fixed in Act
- [2] Pre-2019 salary links fixed in Act

MECHANISM
- [3] 2019 shifts detail to Central rules
- [4] Change covers Central Commissions
- [5] Change also covers State Commissions
- [6] Rules prescribe three-year term

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Independence concern is structural
- [8] Actual interference is not proved
- VERDICT → State the design risk precisely without claiming that RTI rights were abolished.
- ANSWER USE → Use for institutional-independence evaluation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — State the design risk precisely without claiming that RTI rights were abolished.

09 OSA AND RTI INTERFACE

OSA AND RTI INTERFACE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 10. OSA AND RTI INTERFACE · (1) OSA 1923 REMAINS IN FORCE · (2) ARC RECOMMENDED REPEAL AND RELOCATION · (3) RECOMMENDATION IS NOT ENACTED LAW · (4) RTI SECTION 22 OVERRIDES INCONSISTENCY · (5) SECTION 8 PROTECTS GENUINE INTERESTS

CENTRAL FOCUS → 10. OSA and RTI interface → (1) OSA 1923 remains in force → (2) ARC recommended repeal and relocation → (3) Recommendation is not enacted law

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. OSA and RTI interface
- [1] OSA 1923 remains in force
- [2] ARC recommended repeal and relocation

MECHANISM
- [3] Recommendation is not enacted law
- [4] RTI Section 22 overrides inconsistency
- [5] Section 8 protects genuine interests
- [6] Section 8(2) weighs public interest

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Section 10 narrows withholding
- [8] Reasoned review replaces blanket label
- VERDICT → Official secrecy survives, but it cannot bypass the RTI Act's own decision architecture.
- ANSWER USE → Use for the 2019 direct PYQ.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Official secrecy survives, but it cannot bypass the RTI Act's own decision architecture.

10 PRIVACY AFTER PUTTASWAMY AND DPDP

PRIVACY AFTER PUTTASWAMY AND DPDP · CENTRAL FOCUS · 11. PRIVACY AFTER PUTTASWAMY AND DPDP · (1) PRIVACY PROTECTS DIGNITY AND AUTONOMY · (2) STATE ACTION NEEDS LEGALITY · (3) AIM AND PROPORTIONALITY MATTER · (4) SAFEGUARDS AND REMEDY MATTER · (5) SECTION 44(3) COMMENCED 13 NOV 2025

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. Privacy after Puttaswamy and DPDP → (1) Privacy protects dignity and autonomy → (2) State action needs legality

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. Privacy after Puttaswamy and DPDP
- [1] Privacy protects dignity and autonomy
- [2] State action needs legality

MECHANISM
- [3] Aim and proportionality matter
- [4] Safeguards and remedy matter
- [5] Section 44(3) commenced 13 Nov 2025
- [6] RTI 8(1)(j) text was substituted

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Sections 8(2), 10 and 11 remain
- [8] Sec 6(9): 13 Nov 2026; core: 13 May 2027
- VERDICT → Use current text and acknowledge unresolved interaction instead of reviving deleted wording.
- ANSWER USE → Use for privacy-transparency and current-law answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — Use current text and acknowledge unresolved interaction instead of reviving deleted wording.

11 ETHICAL DIGITAL INFORMATION-SHARING DESIGN

ETHICAL DIGITAL INFORMATION-SHARING DESIGN · CENTRAL FOCUS · 12. ETHICAL DIGITAL INFORMATION-SHARING DESIGN · (1) ESTABLISH LAWFUL AUTHORITY · (2) DEFINE SPECIFIC PURPOSE · (3) SHARE MINIMUM NECESSARY FIELDS · (4) VERIFY ACCURACY AND PROVENANCE · (5) CONTROL ACCESS AND RETENTION

CENTRAL FOCUS → 12. Ethical digital information-sharing design → (1) Establish lawful authority → (2) Define specific purpose → (3) Share minimum necessary fields

CORE CLAIM
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 12. Ethical digital information-sharing design
- [1] Establish lawful authority
- [2] Define specific purpose

MECHANISM
- [3] Share minimum necessary fields
- [4] Verify accuracy and provenance
- [5] Control access and retention
- [6] Publish only safe aggregates

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- [7] Enable correction and appeal
- [8] Audit necessity, use and outcomes
- VERDICT → An accountable State should be transparent about power without making citizens needlessly transparent.
- ANSWER USE → Use for databases, open data and twenty-mark design questions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT — An accountable State should be transparent about power without making citizens needlessly transparent.

E SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · 1. TRANSPARENCY AS AN INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE OF POWER · 2. FROM PROACTIVE DISCLOSURE TO INFORMATION STEWARDSHIP · 3. EXEMPTION REASONING · CLASS, HARM, BALANCE AND NARROWNESS · 4. SEVERABILITY, MOSAIC RISK AND CALIBRATED ACCESS · 5. THIRD-PARTY PROCEDURE AND MULTI-PARTY FAIRNESS · 6. ENFORCEMENT QUALITY AND INSTITUTIONAL INDEPENDENCE

OPTIONAL ETHICAL DEPTH
- 1. Transparency as an information architecture of power
- 2. From proactive disclosure to information stewardship
- 3. Exemption reasoning: class, harm, balance and narrowness
- 4. Severability, mosaic risk and calibrated access

ADVANCED LIMIT / TRADE-OFF
- 5. Third-party procedure and multi-party fairness
- 6. Enforcement quality and institutional independence
- 7. Official Secrets Act: conflict of norms and administrative culture
- 8. Privacy after Puttaswamy and the changed Section 8(1)(j)

ADMINISTRATIVE APPLICATION
- 9. Information sharing, interoperability and open-government limits
- 10. Advanced answer synthesis, reforms and source boundaries
- identify likely recurring information demands when a programme is created;
- structure records to answer them;

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels